



# OBJECT ORIENTED SYSTEMS (OOS) — 2022

## QUESTION 6 COMPLETE DETAILED SOLUTION

---



### Introduction

Question 6 of the 2022 Object Oriented Systems examination belongs to CO5 and focuses on one of the most important and industry-relevant topics in software engineering:



### Design Patterns

Design patterns are reusable solutions to commonly occurring software design problems. Instead of reinventing solutions repeatedly, software engineers use proven design structures known as design patterns to build:

- scalable systems,
- maintainable applications,
- reusable architectures,
- and loosely coupled software.

Modern enterprise applications, frameworks, and APIs rely heavily on design patterns. Technologies such as:

- Spring Framework,
- Java Collections Framework,
- Android Development,
- Hibernate,
- and GUI systems

use design patterns extensively 🚀 🍵 .

This question mainly focuses on:

- essential elements of design patterns,
- and the **Command Pattern**.

Understanding these topics deeply is extremely important for both:

- university examinations,
- and real-world software engineering interviews.



---

### QUESTION 6(a)



**Discuss the essential elements of a design pattern.**



### Answer

A **Design Pattern** is a generalized reusable solution to a recurring software design problem. Design patterns are not complete programs or ready-made code libraries. Instead, they are proven templates or blueprints that describe how classes and objects should interact to solve common design challenges efficiently.

The concept of design patterns became highly popular through the famous book:  *"Design Patterns: Elements of Reusable Object-Oriented Software"* written by the Gang of Four (GoF).

The primary objective of design patterns is to improve:

- reusability,
- flexibility,
- maintainability,
- extensibility,
- and software quality.

Without design patterns, large software systems often become tightly coupled, difficult to maintain, and error-prone .

## Why Design Patterns are Needed?

In real-world software development, developers repeatedly encounter similar problems such as:

- object creation,
- communication between objects,
- interface adaptation,
- algorithm encapsulation,
- and behavior management.

If every programmer solves these problems differently, software becomes inconsistent and difficult to scale. Design patterns provide:

- standardized solutions,
- proven architectures,
- and best software engineering practices .

## Essential Elements of a Design Pattern

Every design pattern contains certain fundamental elements that describe the pattern completely. These essential elements help developers understand:

- the purpose of the pattern,
- when to use it,
- how it works,
- and what consequences it produces.

The essential elements are discussed below in detail:

### ◆ 1. Pattern Name

The first essential element is the **Pattern Name**. The pattern name provides a concise identity to the design solution. It helps developers communicate efficiently using a common vocabulary. For example:

- Singleton Pattern
- Factory Pattern
- Observer Pattern

- Command Pattern

Instead of explaining the entire architecture repeatedly, developers can simply mention the pattern name. For example, "*Use Singleton here*" immediately conveys a complete design idea to experienced programmers 💡. Thus, pattern names improve communication, documentation, and architectural understanding.

## ♦ 2. Problem

The second essential element is the **Problem**. This section explains:

- what design issue the pattern solves,
- under what conditions it should be applied,
- and what context leads to the problem.

Without understanding the problem properly, developers may misuse patterns unnecessarily ⚠️. For example:

- Singleton solves the multiple object creation issue.
- Observer solves the object notification dependency issue.
- Command pattern solves the request encapsulation problem.

Thus the problem section identifies the exact software challenge.

## ♦ 3. Solution

The third essential element is the **Solution**. This section describes:

- classes involved,
- object relationships,
- interactions,
- and overall structure.

The solution does NOT provide exact code because implementation may vary between programming languages and project requirements. Instead, it provides an architectural blueprint, collaboration structure, and behavioral organization. For example, the Observer pattern solution contains **Subject**, **Observer**, and **ConcreteObserver** and defines how they interact dynamically.

## ♦ 4. Consequences

The fourth essential element is the **Consequences**. This section explains:

- advantages,
- disadvantages,
- trade-offs,
- and performance impacts.

Every design pattern improves certain aspects while potentially introducing complexity elsewhere. For example:

- Singleton improves controlled object creation, but excessive Singleton usage may increase global dependency.
- Observer improves loose coupling, but too many observers may create performance overhead.

Thus consequences help developers evaluate whether the pattern is suitable for a given scenario 🗨️.

## ☀️ Summary Table of Essential Elements

| Essential Element | Purpose                         |
|-------------------|---------------------------------|
| Pattern Name      | Identifies the pattern          |
| Problem           | Describes design issue          |
| Solution          | Provides structural approach    |
| Consequences      | Explains results and trade-offs |

## ☀️ Real-World Importance of Design Patterns

Design patterns are extensively used in:

- enterprise applications,
- operating systems,
- GUI frameworks,
- distributed systems,
- and web frameworks.

For example:

- Java Collections uses the Iterator Pattern.
- Spring Framework uses Factory and Singleton Patterns.
- GUI buttons use the Command Pattern.

Thus design patterns form the foundation of modern software architecture 🚀.

## 🎯 Conclusion

The essential elements of a design pattern provide complete understanding of the pattern's purpose, structure, applicability, and consequences. These elements help software engineers design scalable, maintainable, and reusable object-oriented systems effectively.

---

## 📄 QUESTION 6(b)

❓ **Explain Command Pattern with suitable examples.**

✅ Answer

The **Command Pattern** is one of the most important behavioral design patterns in Object-Oriented Programming. It encapsulates a request as an object so that requests can be:

- parameterized,
- queued,
- logged,
- undone,

- and executed dynamically.

Instead of directly calling methods, the request itself becomes an independent object. This design pattern promotes loose coupling, extensibility, flexibility, and command abstraction 🚀.

### 🌟 Why Command Pattern is Needed?

Suppose a remote control directly controls every electronic device. Without command pattern, the remote becomes tightly coupled with device implementations. Any device modification would require remote modification. This creates poor software design ⚠️.

Command pattern solves this problem by separating the **request sender** from the **request executor**. Thus the sender does not need to know implementation details.

### 🌟 Real-World Analogy

Consider a restaurant 🍽️.

1. Customer gives order.
2. Waiter carries order.
3. Chef prepares food.

Here:

- **Customer** → Invoker
- **Waiter** → Command
- **Chef** → Receiver

The waiter encapsulates the request and forwards it without knowing cooking details. This perfectly represents the Command Pattern 💡.

### 🌟 Components of Command Pattern

| Component              | Responsibility       |
|------------------------|----------------------|
| <b>Command</b>         | Declares execute()   |
| <b>ConcreteCommand</b> | Implements command   |
| <b>Receiver</b>        | Performs actual work |
| <b>Invoker</b>         | Triggers command     |
| <b>Client</b>          | Creates objects      |

### 🌟 UML Structure of Command Pattern

Client → Invoker → Command → Receiver

### 🌟 Step-by-Step Working

The working process is as follows:

1. Client creates command object.
2. Command object stores receiver object.
3. Invoker triggers command.
4. Command calls receiver method.
5. Receiver performs actual operation.

Thus the sender remains decoupled from implementation.

### ✓ Complete Java Program

```
// Command Interface
interface Command {
    void execute();
}

// Receiver Class
class Light {
    void turnOn() {
        System.out.println("Light Turned ON");
    }
}

// Concrete Command
class LightOnCommand implements Command {
    private Light light;

    LightOnCommand(Light light) {
        this.light = light;
    }

    public void execute() {
        light.turnOn();
    }
}

// Invoker Class
class RemoteControl {
    private Command command;

    void setCommand(Command command) {
        this.command = command;
    }

    void pressButton() {
        command.execute();
    }
}

// Client
class Demo {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Light light = new Light();
```

```
        Command cmd = new LightOnCommand(light);

        RemoteControl remote = new RemoteControl();
        remote.setCommand(cmd);
        remote.pressButton();
    }
}
```

## Output

Light Turned ON

## 🌟 Deep Explanation of Program

Let us now understand the internal working carefully because this is extremely important for exams 🧠.

### ◆ Command Interface

```
interface Command
```

This defines a common command structure. Every command must implement the `execute()` method.

### ◆ Receiver Class

```
class Light
```

This class performs actual work. The method `turnOn()` contains real business logic.

### ◆ Concrete Command

```
class LightOnCommand
```

Encapsulates the request. It stores the receiver object and invokes the receiver method. Thus the request becomes an independent object.

### ◆ Invoker

```
class RemoteControl
```

The invoker simply triggers command execution. It does NOT know how the light works, how `turnOn()` works, or the implementation details. Thus loose coupling is achieved 🚀.

## ☀ Advantages of Command Pattern

Command Pattern provides numerous advantages:

- Firstly, it promotes loose coupling because sender and receiver remain independent.
- Secondly, new commands can be added easily without modifying existing code.
- Thirdly, command objects can support undo operations, logging, transaction management, and queuing.
- Finally, it improves maintainability and extensibility significantly.

## ⚠ Disadvantages

Although powerful, command pattern may increase:

- number of classes,
- design complexity,
- and abstraction layers.

Thus it should be used when flexibility is truly needed.

## ☀ Real-World Applications

Command Pattern is widely used in:

- GUI buttons,
- menu systems,
- remote controls,
- transaction systems,
- undo-redo editors,
- macro recording software.

For example, clicking the Undo button in MS Word internally uses the command pattern.

## ☀ Difference Between Direct Call and Command Pattern

| Direct Method Call     | Command Pattern        |
|------------------------|------------------------|
| Tightly coupled        | Loosely coupled        |
| Hard to extend         | Easily extensible      |
| No command abstraction | Request becomes object |
| Difficult undo support | Easy undo support      |

## 🎯 Conclusion

The Command Pattern encapsulates requests as objects and separates request generation from request execution. This improves flexibility, loose coupling, extensibility, and maintainability, making it one of the most powerful behavioral design patterns in Object-Oriented Programming 🚀.